

Yuncong Hu

Assistant Professor at Shanghai Jiao Tong University
Ph.D. at UC Berkeley

Personal Information

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Research Interests

I am broadly interested in systems security and applied cryptography. My current research focuses on secure decentralized systems and zero-knowledge proofs.

Education

2017-2022 Doctor of Philosophy in Computer Science, UC Berkeley
Advisors: Prof. Raluca Ada Popa and Prof. Alessandro Chiesa
Thesis: Decentralized Ledgers: Design and Applications

2017-2020 Master of Science in Computer Science, UC Berkeley
Advisors: Prof. Raluca Ada Popa and Prof. Alessandro Chiesa
Thesis: Broadcast Encryption with Fine-grained Delegation and its Application to IoT

2013-2017 Bachelor in Computer Science, Shanghai Jiao Tong University (SJTU), China
ACM Honored Class, Zhiyuan College

Selected Publications

- *zkAgent: Verifiable LLM Agent Execution via One-Shot Transcript Proofs*
Lizheng Wang, Hancheng Lou, Chongrong Li, Yu Yu, Yuncong Hu (corresponding author)
CCS 2026 (33rd ACM Conference on Computer and Communications Security)
- *HasteBoots: Proving TFHE Programmable Bootstrapping in Seconds*
Fengrun Liu, Haofei Liang, Xiang Xie, Yu Yu, Wenting Zheng, Yuncong Hu (corresponding author)
USENIX Security 2026 (35th USENIX Security Symposium)
- *Secure Lookup Tables: Faster, Leaner, and More General*
Chongrong Li, Pengfei Zhu, Yun Li, Zhanpeng Guo, Jingyu Li, Yuncong Hu (corresponding author), Zhicong Huang, Cheng Hong
IEEE S&P 2026 (47th IEEE Symposium on Security and Privacy)
- *Distributed Vector Commitments and Their Applications*
Rui Gao, Huaqun Wang, Zhiguo Wan, Yuncong Hu (corresponding author)
USENIX Security 2026 (35th USENIX Security Symposium)
- *DFS: Delegation-friendly zkSNARK and Private Delegation of Provers*
Yuncong Hu, Pratyush Mishra, Xiao Wang, Jie Xie, Kang Yang, Yu Yu, Yuwen Zhang
USENIX Security 2025 (34th USENIX Security Symposium)
- *Plontank: An FPGA-based zk-SNARK Acceleration System for Secure Computing*
Dahong Qian, Yiyang Xu, Yuncong Hu (corresponding author)
JPDC 2025 (Journal of Parallel and Distributed Computing)
- *A Succinct Range Proof for Polynomial-based Vector Commitment*
Rui Gao, Zhiguo Wan, Yuncong Hu (corresponding author), Huaqun Wang
CCS 2024 (31th ACM Conference on Computer and Communications Security)

- [*HuRef: HUMAN-REadable Fingerprint for Large Language Models*](#)
Boyi Zeng, Lizheng Wang, *Yuncong Hu*, Yi Xu, Chenghu Zhou, Xinbing Wang, Yu Yu, Zhouhan Lin
NeurIPS 2024 (38th Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems)
- [*VPNNT: A Verifiable and Privacy-Preserving Neural Network Training Framework*](#)
Haohua Duan, Zedong Peng, Liyao Xiang, *Yuncong Hu*, Bo Li
TDSC 2024 (IEEE Transactions on Dependable and Secure Computing)
- [*Hadamard Product Argument from Lagrange-Based Univariate Polynomials*](#)
Jie Xie, *Yuncong Hu* (corresponding author), Yu Yu
ACISP 2024 (29th Australasian Conference on Information Security and Privacy)
- [*Gemini: Elastic SNARKs for Diverse Environments*](#)
(alphabetical order) Jonathan Bootle, Alessandro Chiesa, *Yuncong Hu* and Michele Orrù
Eurocrypt 2022 (41st Annual International Conference on the Theory and Applications of Cryptographic Techniques)
- [*Non-Interactive Differentially Anonymous Router*](#)
(alphabetical order) Benedikt Bünz, *Yuncong Hu*, Shin'ichiro Matsuo and Elaine Shi
Cryptology ePrint Archive 2021
- [*Merkle²: A Low-Latency Transparency Log System*](#)
Yuncong Hu, Kian Hooshmand, Harika Kalidhindi, Seung Jin Yang, Raluca Ada Popa
S&P 2021 (42nd IEEE Symposium on Security and Privacy)
- [*Marlin: Preprocessing zkSNARKs with Universal and Updatable SRS*](#)
(alphabetical order) Alessandro Chiesa, *Yuncong Hu*, Mary Maller, Pratyush Mishra, Noah Vesely, and Nicholas P. Ward
Eurocrypt 2020 (39th Annual International Conference on the Theory and Applications of Cryptographic Techniques)
- [*Ghostor: Toward a Secure Data-Sharing System from Decentralized Trust*](#)
Yuncong Hu, Sam Kumar, and Raluca Ada Popa
NSDI 2020 (17th USENIX Symposium on Networked Systems Design and Implementation)
- [*JEDI: Many-to-Many End-to-End Encryption and Key Delegation for IoT*](#)
Sam Kumar, *Yuncong Hu*, Michael P Andersen, Raluca Ada Popa, and David E. Culler
USENIX Security 2019 (28th USENIX Security Symposium)

Open Source Projects

- [*Merkle²: A Low-Latency Transparency Log System*](#) (S&P 2021)
 - A Go library that implements a low-latency transparency log system and a new authenticated data structure. Our system can support 100x more users than prior state-of-the-art key transparency systems.
- [*Arkworks: An Ecosystem for Developing and Programming with zkSNARKs*](#)
 - A modular, coherent Rust ecosystem that provides a low-cost abstraction for developing and programming with zkSNARKs. Our ecosystem has been used in several blockchain companies (such as Aleo) for building applications with zkSNARKs.
 - The [*Marlin*](#) library implements a preprocessing zkSNARK for R1CS with universal and updatable SRS and is published at Eurocrypt 2020.
 - The [*Gemini*](#) library implements an elastic zkSNARK for R1CS and is published at Eurocrypt 2022.

- [JEDI: Many-to-Many End-to-End Encryption and Key Delegation for IoT](#) (USENIX Security 2019)
 - A Golang library that implements a secure many-to-many messaging protocol with decentralized key delegations for IoT devices. Our library has been used in a decentralized authorization framework that has been running for more than 2 years, with more than 800 IoT devices.

Selected Talks

- **Gemini: Elastic SNARKs for Diverse Environments**
 - ChinaCrypt 2023
 - [CMU Cylab Crypto Seminar 2022](#)
- **Merkle²: A Low-Latency Transparency Log System**
 - RISELab Retreat Summer 2021
 - [S&P 2021](#) (42nd IEEE Symposium on Security and Privacy)
- **Marlin: Preprocessing zkSNARKs with Universal and Updatable SRS**
 - [Eurocrypt 2020](#) (39th Annual International Conference on the Theory and Applications of Cryptographic Techniques)
- **Ghostor: Toward a Secure Data-Sharing System from Decentralized Trust**
 - RISELab Retreat Winter 2020, Summer 2019, Winter 2019, Summer 2018.
 - Microsoft Research Redmond Cryptography Colloquium 2020.
- **JEDI: Many-to-Many End-to-End Encryption and Key Delegation for IoT**
 - RISELab Retreat Summer 2019, Summer 2018, Winter 2018.
 - Stanford Secure Internet of Things Project 2018.

Selected Scholarships, Grants, and Awards

- National Natural Science Foundation of China (Grant Nos. 62502306), 2025
- Xiaomi Young Talent Program, 2025
- Shanghai Science and Technology Program (Grant Nos. 24BC3200200), 2024
- Science Fund Program for Excellent Young Scientists (Overseas), 2023
- Shanghai Overseas High-level Young Talents, 2023
- ExploreX Research Grant, Shanghai Jiao Tong University, 2022
- Berkeley Graduate Division Conference Travel Grant, University of California, Berkeley, 2020
- Hui-Chun Chin and Tsung-Dao Lee Chinese Undergraduate Research Endowment Receiver, Shanghai Jiao Tong University, 2017
- Boot Camp Project Grand Prize Winners (top 1), IC3-Ethereum Crypto Boot Camp and Workshop, 2016
 - [Blog and Report](#)
- International Collegiate Programming Contest (ACM-ICPC) Asia Regional
 - 10th Place in Taichung site, 2014

- Gold Medal in Hangzhou site, 2013

Service

PROGRAM COMMITTEE Asiacrypt 2023, USENIX Security 2024

Work Experience

Summer 2021 Research intern at NTT Research Lab, advised by Prof. Elaine Shi
 and Prof. Shin'ichiro Matsuo
Fall 2016 Research intern at Cornell University, advised by Prof. Elaine Shi

Teaching

Spring 2024 Introduction to Blockchains, Shanghai Jiao Tong University
Fall 2023 Introduction to Cryptography, Shanghai Jiao Tong University